

Aviv Gelfand

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in aviv-gelfand

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Summary

- Early-career Data Scientist with practical, result-oriented experience in DS roles across tech (production-grade), academia, military, and training. MSc in progress (Data Science, HUJI); BSc Statistics & Data Science (HUJI, GPA: 89).
- Proven ability to design and implement impactful ML solutions — from classic models to LLMs — in complex, real-world settings, combining high-level software engineering practices with collaborative workflows and rapid self-learning.
- Dedicated to long-term growth in a full-time role in a DS / ML Engineering team with a positive atmosphere where I can grow, contribute meaningfully, and help turn innovative ideas into reality.

Experience

Data Scientist

2024 – present

Darrow AI - Data Science Team

- Developed into production a pipeline of enriching leads databases with domain-focused knowledge. Utilized web-scraping intersecting sources, developing a few-shot CoT model Open AI Batch API calls, enabling filtering and finding 1M\$ leads.
- Performed numerous model evaluation and error analysis tasks, collaborated with senior Data Scientists, PMs and other stakeholders, worked with AWS environment, Airflow, Atlassian (JIRA), Elastic, and tabular databases.

NLP Data Scientist / Research Assistant

2023 – 2024

Hebrew University of Jerusalem - Dr. Adi Leibovitch's Quantitative Legal Research lab

- Executed Supervised-Fine-Tuning of open-source LLMs to classify textual argument-types in trials; reduced labeling time and errors, replacing manual tagging with LLM-based tagging.
- Achieved over 90% accuracy and 80% F1 scores in most target labels. Saved days of model complexity and training time using efficient sampling, overcoming significant imbalance. Presented findings and achievements at a prominent statistics and data science conference in May 2024.

Statistics & Machine Learning Instructor

2022 – 2024

Upscale Analytics

- Built dozens of ML hands-on projects for a Machine Learning and Statistical Inference course, with constant feedback from a Senior Data Scientist (and head lecturer), Michael Winer. Instructed data analysts in tech through their first steps in statistical inference and classic machine learning using Scikit-Learn, SciPy, and XGBoost Libraries.
- Advanced from teaching assistant to instructor, then to a partner role. 3 successful semesters of weekly TA sessions with a significant presence of students.

Programmer and Research Assistant

2022 – 2023

Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Renana Peres's Computational Social Science Lab

- Self-taught and programmed smart contracts with a C++-based programming language; and developed a simulation interface (React.js). Designed and analyzed experiments, web-scraped data monthly, and did literature and academic peer reviews.

Data Analyst & Research Team Leader

2015 – 2020

Israel Defense Forces (Volunteered, Lieutenant)

- Conducted research, assessments, and analytics for high-ranked decision-makers and to 3x our strategic products.
- Led cross-organizational projects. Achieved several in-depth research papers with an unprecedented collaboration between research branches.

Education

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2024 – 2026

MSc in Data Science — LLMs-focused Thesis, guided by Prof. Ariel Jaffe.

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2021 – 2024

BSc in Statistics & Data Science (GPA 89)

Skills and Technologies

Scripting Languages and Tools: Python, Java, Solidity (C++ based), R, SQL, JS

GenAI Tools: Prompt engineering (COT, Few-Shot, etc), structured output schemas; Pydantic, HF

EDA & ETL: Visualizing, Cleaning, Encoding / Embedding; DataBricks, DataGrip, OpenSearch (Elastic)

ML: Efficient Sampling methods, Parameter Optimization, Evaluation Metrics

CI/CD & Other: GIT, Docker files, Aiflow, GitHub workflows, sh scripts, DataDog (on-call)